Medicine Buying Habits: Student Research Survey

CSE398 Capstone Project, Independent University, Bangladesh

This survey is part of a CSE398 capstone project at Independent University, Bangladesh. We are designing a mobile app that reads a doctor's prescription and shows cheaper medicines with the same generic name, strength and form. Your answers will help us decide which features the app should have.

What we ask: questions about how you buy medicines and what features you would want in such an app. It takes about 5 to 7 minutes.

Your privacy

1. The survey is anonymous. We do not collect your name, phone number or email unless you choose to give it in the last optional question.
2. Do not write any personal medical details, such as your illness or the names of your medicines.
3. Responses are stored in the project team's IUB Google account and seen only by the team and our course faculty.
4. We will use the results only for this university project and report them as totals and percentages. No individual answer will be shown.
5. All responses will be deleted after the course ends (by [date]).
6. Taking part is voluntary. You may skip any question or stop at any time.

Contact: [Name], [IUB email]

Consent

Q1. Have you read the information above, and do you agree to take part in this survey? * (Choose one)

- ○ Yes, I am 18 or older and I agree to take part.
- ○ No, I do not agree. (Form ends)

Section 1: About you

Q2. Your age (Choose one)

- ○ 18 to 25
- ○ 26 to 40
- ○ 41 to 60
- ○ Over 60

Q3. Where do you live? (Choose one)

- ○ Dhaka city
- ○ Other city
- ○ Town or village

Q4. Who do you usually buy medicines for? (Choose all that apply)

- ○ Myself
- ○ Parents or elderly family members
- ○ Children
- ○ Spouse or other family

Section 2: How you buy medicines

Q5. How often do you or your family buy medicines? (Choose one)

- ○ Every week
- ○ Every month
- ○ Every few months
- ○ Rarely

Q6. About how much does your household spend on medicines each month? (Choose one)

- ○ Less than ৳500
- ○ ৳500 to ৳2,000
- ○ ৳2,000 to ৳5,000
- ○ More than ৳5,000
- ○ Prefer not to say

Q7. Does anyone in your family take medicine regularly (for example, for diabetes, blood pressure or heart disease)? (Choose one)

- ○ Yes
- ○ No
- ○ Prefer not to say

Q8. Where do you usually buy medicines? (Choose all that apply)

- ○ Local pharmacy
- ○ Hospital pharmacy
- ○ Online pharmacy (Arogga, Osudpotro, etc.)
- ○ Other

Q9. When you buy medicine, what do you usually do? (Choose one)

- ○ Buy exactly the brand written on the prescription
- ○ Buy whatever the pharmacist gives
- ○ Ask the pharmacist for a cheaper option
- ○ Compare prices myself

Section 3: Awareness and trust

Q10. Did you know that the same medicine (same generic) is often sold under many brands at different prices? (Choose one)

- ○ Yes, I knew
- ○ I had heard about it, but I'm not sure
- ○ No, I did not know

Q11. Have you ever had trouble reading a doctor's handwriting on a prescription? (Choose one)

- ○ Often
- ○ Sometimes
- ○ Never

Q12. If a cheaper brand had the same generic and strength, would you buy it instead? (Choose one)

- ○ Yes, definitely
- ○ Yes, if my doctor or pharmacist agrees
- ○ Maybe, depends on the company
- ○ No, I prefer the brand my doctor wrote

Q13. What would make you trust a cheaper brand? (Choose up to 2)

- ○ A well-known manufacturer
- ○ My doctor's approval
- ○ My pharmacist's advice
- ○ Information showing it is DGDA registered
- ○ Good reviews from other users
- ○ Nothing; I would not switch

Q14. How much does each matter to you when choosing a medicine brand? (Grid: 1 (not important) to 5 (very important))

- ○ Low price
- ○ Trusted manufacturer
- ○ Easy to find in pharmacies

Section 4: Technology use

Q15. What kind of phone do you mainly use? (Choose one)

- ○ Android
- ○ iPhone
- ○ Basic phone (no internet)

Q16. How is your mobile internet usually? (Choose one)

- ○ Always good
- ○ Sometimes slow
- ○ Often slow or unavailable

Q17. Which language do you prefer for apps? (Choose one)

- ○ Bangla
- ○ English
- ○ Both

Q18. Would you be comfortable taking a photo of your prescription in an app? (Choose one)

- ○ Yes
- ○ Yes, if the photo is not saved
- ○ No

Section 5: Your experience and your needs

Please answer these in your own words first. There are no right or wrong answers.

Q19. Think about the last time you bought medicine from a prescription. What happened, and what was the hardest or most frustrating part? (Paragraph)

Q20. Imagine an app that helps you with your prescription and medicine costs. What would you want it to do for you? (Paragraph)

Q21. What information would you need to see before you agree to switch to a different brand? (Paragraph)

Section 6: Why you would choose this app

This section helps us understand what would make you pick the app, and what would make you leave it.

Q22. What would be your main reason to use an app like this? (Choose up to 2)

- ○ Save money on medicines
- ○ Avoid reading unclear handwriting
- ○ Check what the pharmacist suggests
- ○ Know all my options before I buy
- ○ Save time at the pharmacy
- ○ Help a parent or family member
- ○ I would not use it

Q23. What would make you choose this app over asking the pharmacist or searching online? (Choose up to 2)

- ○ It is faster
- ○ It shows prices from many brands at once
- ○ It is more neutral than a shop
- ○ It works in Bangla
- ○ It works with a photo, no typing
- ○ It is free
- ○ Nothing; I would still ask the pharmacist

Q24. What would make you trust the app's results? (Choose up to 2)

- ○ Prices shown with their source and date
- ○ DGDA registration status shown
- ○ Manufacturer name shown
- ○ A clear note when a medicine should not be switched
- ○ Approval or advice from a doctor or pharmacist
- ○ Reviews from other users

Q25. What would make you stop using the app after trying it? (Choose up to 2)

- ○ Wrong medicine read from my photo
- ○ Prices that are out of date
- ○ Too many steps
- ○ Needs fast internet
- ○ Slow to load
- ○ Worry about my privacy
- ○ Cheaper brand was not available at the pharmacy

Q26. How much would you need to save before the app felt worth using? (Choose one)

- ○ Any amount
- ○ At least ৳50 per prescription
- ○ At least ৳100 per prescription
- ○ At least ৳200 per prescription
- ○ Saving is not my main reason

Q27. How willing are you to use the app's suggestion when your doctor wrote a different brand? (Choose one)

- ○ I would switch without asking
- ○ I would ask my doctor or pharmacist first
- ○ I would switch only for some medicines
- ○ I would not switch

Section 7: Features you want

Now we would like your views on specific ideas.

Q28. How would you prefer to enter your prescription into an app? (Choose one)

- ○ Take a photo of it
- ○ Type the medicine names
- ○ Choose from a list
- ○ Ask a pharmacist or family member to do it

Q29. When the app shows other brands, what should it show? (Choose all that apply)

- ○ Price per tablet
- ○ Total cost for the whole prescription
- ○ How much money I save
- ○ Manufacturer name
- ○ Whether it is DGDA registered
- ○ Where I can buy it nearby
- ○ Whether it is in stock
- ○ Other: _____

Q30. How many options would you like to see for each medicine? (Choose one)

- ○ Only the single best option
- ○ 2 to 3 options (cheapest, best, recommended)
- ○ All available brands
- ○ A few options, with a button to see all

Q31. How important is each feature to you? (Grid: Must have / Nice to have / Not needed)

- ○ Scan a prescription photo
- ○ Show cheaper brands with the same generic
- ○ Show total savings
- ○ Warn when a medicine should not be switched
- ○ Search medicines without internet
- ○ Bangla language
- ○ Medicine reminders
- ○ Save past prescriptions
- ○ Show nearby pharmacies
- ○ Share the list with family or a pharmacist
- ○ Show price history

Q32. If the app could do only ONE thing well, which should it be? (Choose one)

- ○ Read my prescription correctly
- ○ Find the cheapest option
- ○ Help me choose a safe, trusted alternative
- ○ Show where to buy the medicine

Q33. Is there a feature we have not mentioned that you would like? (optional) (Paragraph)

Q34. Which features should we NOT add because they would make the app confusing? (optional) (Paragraph)

Q35. Would you use an app like this? (Choose one)

- ○ Yes, regularly
- ○ Sometimes
- ○ Maybe once to try
- ○ No

Section 8: Final thoughts (optional)

Q36. Would you like to test our app prototype later? If yes, leave your email or phone number. (Short answer (optional))